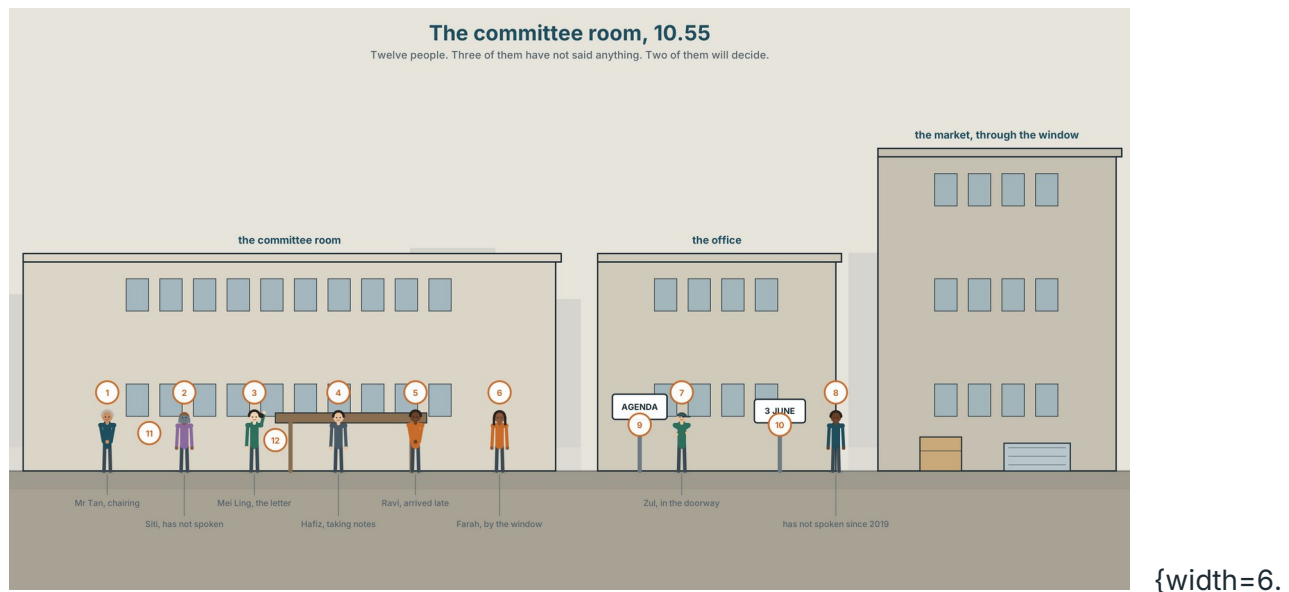


Table of Contents

A2.1 • Unit 10 • Three People Who Cannot Read the Notice

English Animated • *Making Plans* • Pasar Chow Kit, Kuala Lumpur Student's Book pages
204–225 • 22 pp • ~10 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

The committee room, 10.55 — Twelve people. Three of them have not said anything. Two of them will decide.

Who gets to speak?

By the end of this unit you can chair a short meeting and confirm in writing what was agreed.

♦ A • THE WORLD

How a decision gets made in a room,
and who is not in the room

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

question tags • indirect questions • 24
words for meetings and
disagreement • 16 ways of asking
without demanding • the tag that rises
and the tag that falls

♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Ten minutes in the chair, and six lines
in writing afterwards

0A • Find it

Find twelve people in this picture. Three of them have not said anything.

at the table • standing at the back • in the doorway • by the window • taking notes • holding the agenda • looking at a phone • arriving late

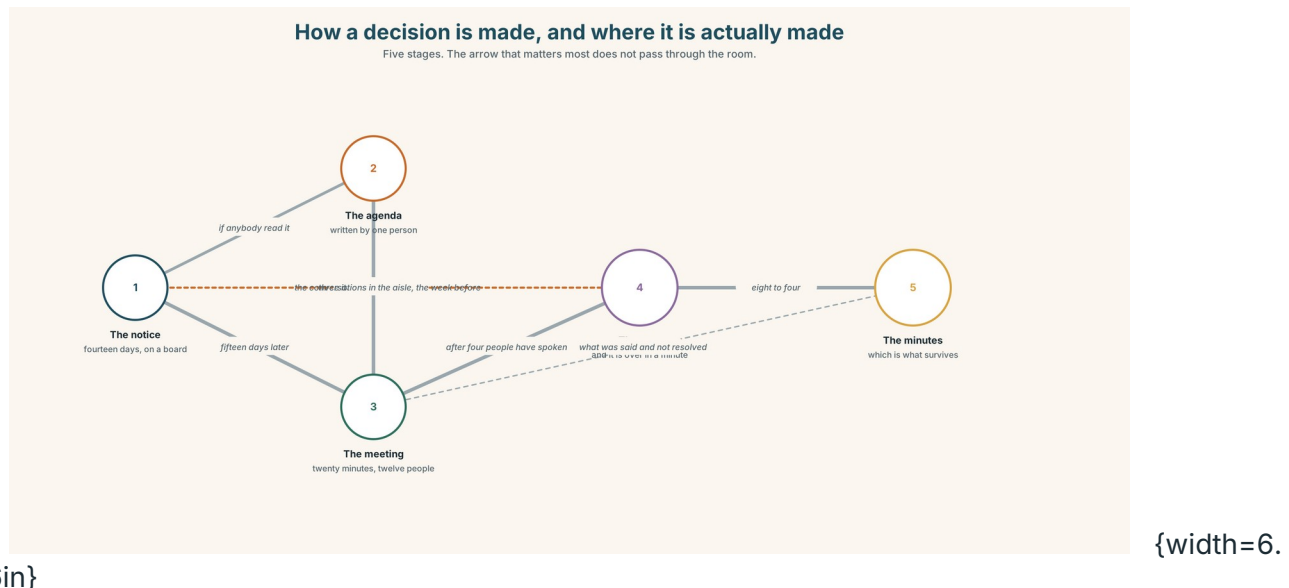
0B • Guess it

Two people in this picture will decide what happens. Which two, and how can you tell? **Neither of them is the one holding the agenda.**

0C • Say it

Record thirty seconds. Think of the last meeting you were in. Who spoke most, and who had most at stake? You will record it again at the end of this unit.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM



How a decision is made, and where it is actually made — Five stages. The arrow that matters most does not pass through the room.

1A • Meet — the words of a meeting

Match each word to one place on the map.

meeting • agenda • minutes • decision • vote • chair • turn • opinion • suggestion • argument

1B • Sort — before, during, or after?

Three columns.

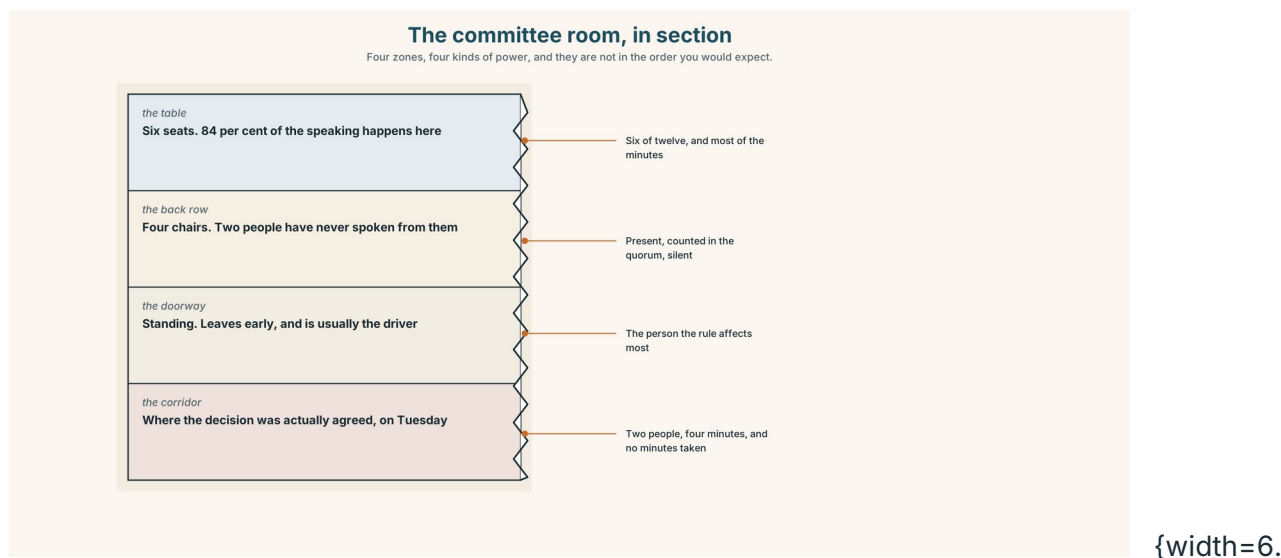
agenda • vote • minutes • suggestion • decision • opinion • argument • meeting

One of them happens at all three stages. Which, and give an example of each.

1C • Meet — what people do to each other

agree · disagree · interrupt · listen · speak up · quiet

Which of these is a kindness, and which is sometimes the only way to be heard? **Can the same act be both?**



6in}

The committee room, in section — Four zones, four kinds of power, and they are not in the order you would expect.

Look at the committee room in section. Four zones, four kinds of power. **Where does the person who decides actually sit, and where does the person who is affected?**

1D • Stretch — the phrases

Complete each one with one word.

- Everybody on this committee should **have a** ____ .
- Four of you are talking. **Take** ____ .
- If you want to say something, **put your** ____ **up**.
- We haven't ____ **from** the fish end at all this morning.
- She never argues in the room. She **speaks** ____ afterwards, to one person.

1E • The saying

f Can I just say

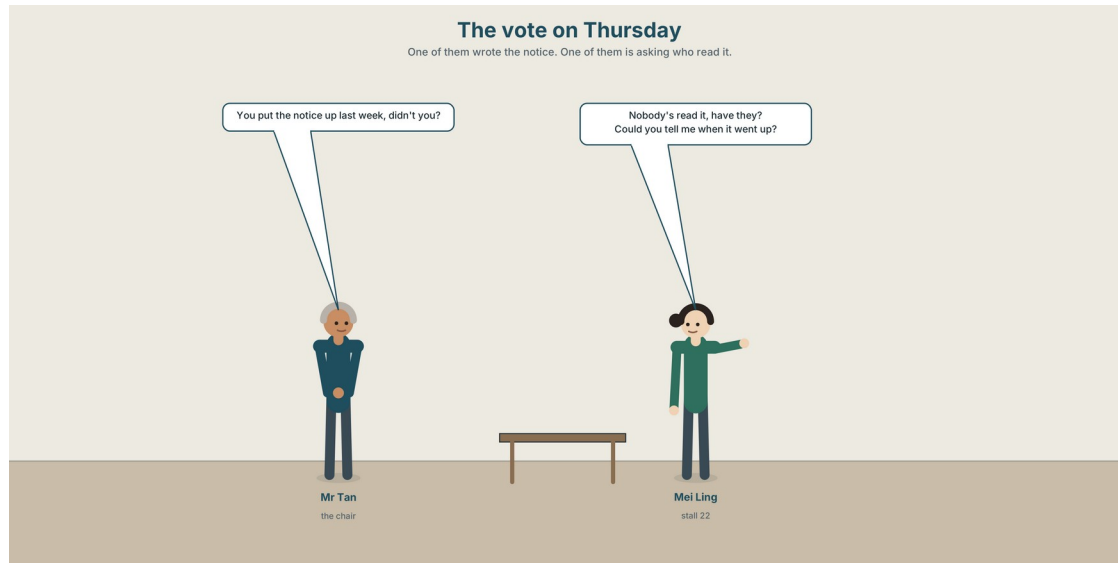
Four words that interrupt politely — or do not.

Say it three times: apologetically, firmly, and as somebody who has been waiting twenty minutes. **Which one would work in your workplace?**

1F • Own it

Think of a group you belong to. Tell a partner **three sentences:** who chairs it, who speaks most, and one person whose opinion you have never heard.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



{width=6.

6in}

The vote on Thursday — One of them wrote the notice. One of them is asking who read it.

2A • The vote on Thursday 🎧 Track 10.1

Before you listen. Twelve traders must vote on a new rule. Three of them cannot read the notice.
Guess: does anybody mention that before the vote?

Listen once. One question. How many people speak in the first four minutes?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	What they want	What they actually say	Who answers them
Mr Tan			
Mei Ling			
Farah			

Listen again. Choose.

- The notice went up **last week / last month / nobody knows**.
- Farah speaks **first / last / not at all**.
- Mei Ling raises the reading problem **directly / as a question / not at all**.
- The vote is **taken / postponed / taken and then re-taken**.

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- You put the notice up last week, didn't you?*
- Nobody's read it, have they?*
- Could you tell me when it went up?*
- Do you know if everybody can read it?*

Two of these are tags. Two are indirect questions. Which pair sounds softer, and which pair is actually harder to answer?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 10.2

Twenty-five seconds. Four jobs.

1. How many tags can you hear?
2. In *didn't you?*, does the voice go up or down?
3. Catch the date the notice went up.
4. One tag is not really a question. Which, and how do you know?

Transcripts, page 159.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Asking without demanding

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2.

1. In sentence 1, is the speaker asking or telling?
2. Sentence 2 is negative with a positive tag. **Why that way round?**
3. In sentence 3, what has happened to the word order of *when did it go up?*
4. Sentence 4 starts *Do you know if*. **What does *if* replace?**
5. Try "*Could you tell me when did it go up?*" **What is wrong?**

3B • See

What happens inside an indirect question
The question word stays. The inversion goes. So does do.

Could you tell me **when** it went up ?

└──────────────────────────┘
the polite opening

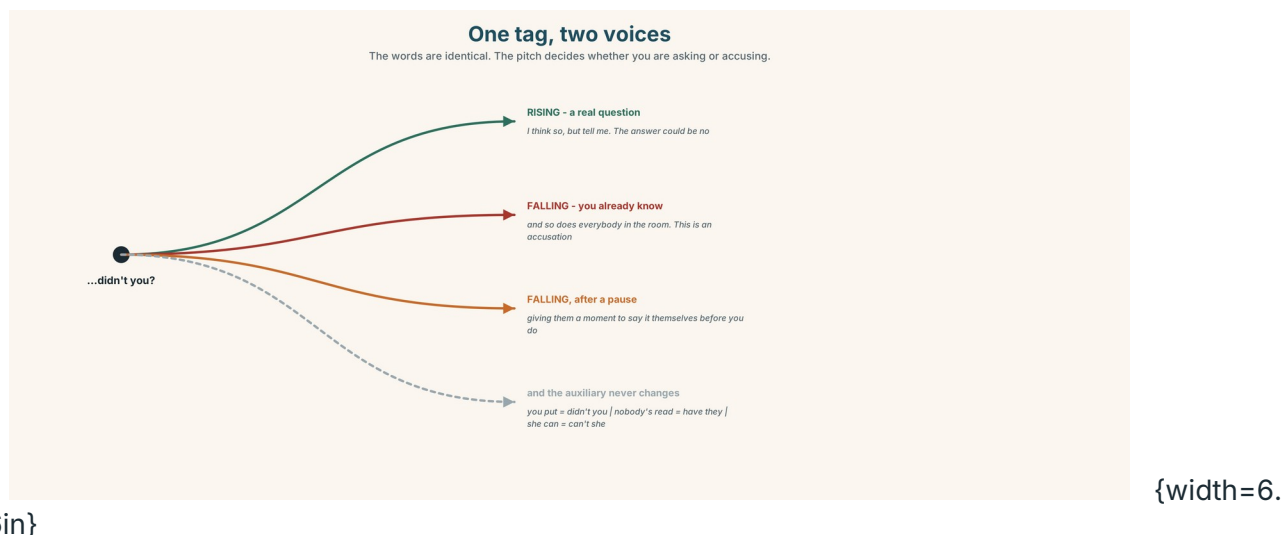
└──┐ └──────────────────────────┘
question word stays statement order - no did, no inversion

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6in}

What happens inside an indirect question — The question word stays. The inversion goes. So does do.

Now look at the second picture. **Two tags, two voices. Which one actually wants an answer?**



6in}

One tag, two voices — The words are identical. The pitch decides whether you are asking or accusing.

3C • Know

	Shape	Example
question tag	positive sentence → negative tag	<i>You put it up last week, didn't you?</i>
	negative sentence → positive tag	<i>Nobody's read it, have they?</i>
indirect question	<i>Could you tell me / Do you know + statement order</i>	<i>Could you tell me when it went up?</i>
	yes/no question → if or whether	<i>Do you know if everybody can read it?</i>

The tag uses the same auxiliary as the sentence. You **put** it up → *didn't* you? · Nobody*'s** read it* → *have* they? · She **can** read → *can't* she?

Intonation does the work. Tag ↗ = a real question. *You put it up last week, didn't you?* ↗ Tag ↘ = you already know. *You put it up last week, didn't you?* ↘ — and that is an accusation.

Watch out. Inside an indirect question, **no inversion and no do**. × *Do you know when did it go up?* ✓ *Do you know when it went up?*

3D • Use — controlled

You put the notice up last week, (1) _____ ? Nobody has read it, (2) _____ ? Could you tell me (3) _____ (when / it / go up) ? And do you know (4) _____ (if / everybody / can read it) ? We should ask them first, (5) _____ ? I'm not being difficult, (6) _____ ?

3E • Use — guided

Add the right tag.

1. You're on the committee, _____ ?
2. She hasn't seen it, _____ ?
3. They voted last month, _____ ?
4. It isn't fair, _____ ?

5. We can postpone it, _____ ?
6. Nobody asked them, _____ ?

3F • Use — open

Ask four people in this room something you half-know, using a tag. Then ask the same thing as an indirect question. **Which got a longer answer?**

3G • Check — six items

1. You put it up last week, _____ ?
2. Nobody has read it, _____ ?
3. Could you tell me _____ (where / the office / be) ?
4. Do you know _____ she is coming? (yes/no)
5. She can read it, _____ ?
6. I was wondering _____ (what time / the meeting / start) .

0-3 → Workbook pp. 58-60. **4-5** → Part 6. **6** → page 217.

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — the tag chain

One learner makes a statement. The next adds a tag and answers it. **Thirty seconds each.**

"You came by bus." → "You came by bus, didn't you? — No, I walked." → ...

The chain breaks on a wrong auxiliary.

4B • The functional core — chairing

Who is in the room, and who is affected

Learner A has the attendance list. Learner B has the list of who the rule touches.

in the room

nine of twelve, and six of them silent



affected by it

twelve, and three could not read the notice



How many people are in both lists, and how many in only one?

7 differences — find them all

{width=6.

6in}

Who is in the room, and who is affected — Learner A has the attendance list. Learner B has the list of who the rule touches.

Language Bank

opening	<i>Shall we start? · There are three things. · We've got twenty minutes.</i>
bringing somebody in	<i>We haven't heard from... · Farah, what do you think?</i>
holding the floor	<i>Can I just say · Sorry — let her finish. · One at a time.</i>
closing	<i>So we've agreed... · Is that everybody? · I'll write that up.</i>

Role play. Groups of five. One chairs, four have different interests. **Ten minutes, one decision.** The chair must bring in the quietest person by minute six.

4C • The performance — chairing, ten minutes

Chair the meeting. You must:

state the question in one sentence · hear from everybody at least once · name the decision out loud before you end · say who is doing what

Record the last two minutes.

4D • Observer

One person counts **who spoke, and for how long**. Report the two numbers, not the opinions.

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did everybody speak at least once? ☐ Was the decision said out loud before the meeting ended?

Part 5 • Reading A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

A letter and a reply, from the market's correspondence file. The title is **"Re: notice of 3 June."** **What do you expect somebody to be complaining about?** One sentence.

5B • Read — one hundred seconds

From: Mei Ling Chan, stall 22 To: the Traders' Committee Re: notice of 3 June

I am writing about Thursday's vote.

The notice went up on 3 June on the board by the office. Three traders in this market cannot read it. I do not mean they are too busy. I mean that two of them read no English at all and one reads very little, and all three of them have been here longer than I have.

I know that the rules say fourteen days' notice and the notice was up for fifteen. That is not my point. The notice was up. It was not read.

I am not asking you to postpone. I am asking whether anybody went and told them.

From: K. Tan, Manager Re: your letter

Nobody did. I did not think of it and neither did anyone else, and I have been doing this for nine years.

I have postponed the vote to the 24th. Between now and then I will go to all three personally, and the secretary will read the notice aloud at the start of the next three meetings, which is something somebody should have suggested in 2011.

You did not ask me to postpone it. I am aware of that. I am doing it because the alternative is a vote I would have to defend by saying the paperwork was correct, and I would rather not find out whether I could.

5C • Answer

1. When did the notice go up, and for how long?
2. How many traders cannot read it, and how well?
3. **What is Mei Ling's actual question?** It is not the obvious one.
4. What does she specifically say she is **not** asking for?
5. What three things does Mr Tan do in reply?
6. **Why does he say he is postponing it?** Put his reason in your own words.

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

that is not my point · postpone · personally · the alternative · I would rather not find out

5E • The counter-text

The notice of 3 June

Two hundred and six words, one sentence of forty-one, and a board by the office.

PASAR CHOW KIT - NOTICE TO ALL TRADERS

Posted	3 June, board by the office
Vote	Thursday 18 June, 11.00

THE PROPOSED RULE

From 1 August the market will open at 05.00 rather than 04.00, with the exception of the fish and ice bays which may open at 04.30 subject to a separate application being made in writing to the office not later than fourteen days before the date on which the trader wishes the arrangement to commence.

Words in that sentence 41

IF YOU WISH TO OBJECT

How	in writing, to the office
By	14 days from posting
Which is	17 June

Objections received after this date will be recorded but will not be read to the meeting.

THE WHOLE NOTICE:

206 words. No headings. Nine point type. One copy, on one board, facing the office door.

One board, and you have to walk past the office to see it

Forty-one words, and the exception is buried in the middle

In writing - which settles it for three of the twelve

Seventeenth. The vote is on the eighteenth

Recorded, but not read aloud

One copy. The thing that caused all of this

{width=6.

6in}

The notice of 3 June — Two hundred and six words, one sentence of forty-one, and a board by the office.

Read the notice itself and answer.

1. What is the new rule, in one sentence?
2. **What does a trader have to do if they want to object, and by when?**
3. How many words are in the notice, and at what reading level?
4. One sentence in it is forty-one words long. Find it, and rewrite it as three.

5F • Two texts

The letter says the notice was up for **fifteen days**. The notice says objections must be **in writing, to the office, within fourteen days of posting**.

Put those two facts together. How long did a trader actually have? Two sentences.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Asking carefully

From most direct to least
Four ways of asking the same question, and what each one costs you.

1	2	3	4
fastest, and hardest to refuse	neutral - and this is most of speech	easy to deflect, and that is the point	so easy to ignore that it often is
			
"Tell me when it went up."	"When did it go up?"	"Could you tell me when it went up?"	"I was wondering when it went up."
an order			a wondering

{width=6.

6in}

From most direct to least — Four ways of asking the same question, and what each one costs you.

6A • Sort — how direct?

Put these on a line from most direct to least.

When did it go up? · Could you tell me when it went up? · Do you know when it went up? · I was wondering when it went up. · Tell me when it went up.

6B • Chunk completion

1. **Could you** _____ **me** where the office is?
2. **Do you know** _____ she's coming?
3. **Would you** _____ reading it aloud?
4. **I was** _____ whether we could postpone it.
5. We should ask them first, _____ **it**?
6. They're all coming, _____ **they**?

6C • The softeners

perhaps • actually • sorry • could • might

Each of these makes a sentence easier to refuse. Put one in each, and say what it costs you.

1. _____, could we come back to that?
2. I _____ disagree, if that's all right.
3. _____ we should ask them first.
4. _____ I just say something?
5. It _____ be worth waiting.

The tag, and the indirect question
One of them is quicker. The other gets a longer answer.

THE TAG

"...didn't you?" - yes or no, in a second



THE INDIRECT QUESTION

"Could you tell me...?" - and they explain



Which one would you use with somebody you have never met?
6 differences — find them all

{width=6.

The tag, and the indirect question — One of them is quicker. The other gets a longer answer.

Six differences. Find them, then answer the question under the picture.

6D • Contrast Clinic — tag or indirect question

Six items. **Write the better version for the situation given.**

1. You want to check a date with a colleague. (*you are fairly sure*)
 2. You want a date from a stranger in an office.
 3. You suspect somebody forgot, and you want them to admit it.
 4. You want to know whether a meeting is still happening.
 5. You want to disagree without an argument.
 6. You want to interrupt four people who are all talking.
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The tag that rises, and the tag that does not



{width=6.

6in}

The tag that rises, and the tag that does not — Identical words. The last three notes decide what kind of sentence it was.

7A • Hear 🎧 Track 10.3

You put it up last week, didn't you? ↗ — I think so, but tell me You put it up last week, didn't you? ↘ — and we both know you did

7B • Say

Say both. Then say these three with a **rise**, and then with a **fall**:

It isn't fair, is it? · Nobody asked them, did they? · We can postpone it, can't we?

7C • Make it mean something

Say this one three times:

Nobody's read it, have they?

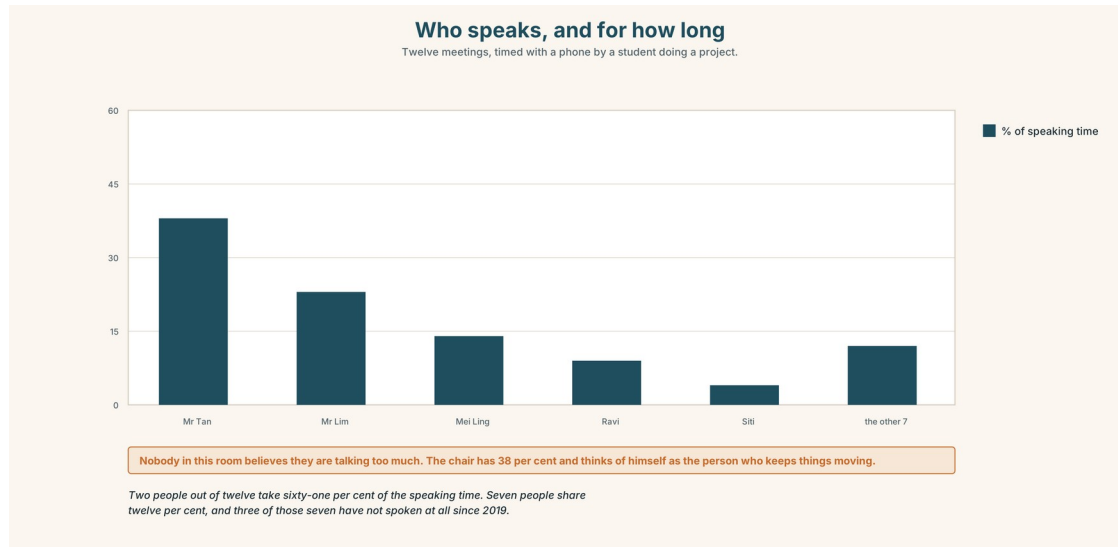
↗ a question · ↘ an accusation · ↘ **with a pause before the tag** — something else again.
What is the third one doing?

7D • Fluency 20 🟡

Twenty seconds: **three tags that rise and three that fall**. Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

What was agreed • 90 words



{width=6.

6in}

Who speaks, and for how long — Twelve meetings, timed with a phone by a student doing a project.

8A • Read the model

Present: nine of twelve. **Apologies:** Ravi, Zul, Farah.

The vote on the opening-hours rule was postponed to the 24th. [the decision, first, in one sentence]

It was agreed that the secretary will read each notice aloud at the start of the meeting, and that Mr Tan will visit the three traders who cannot read the notice before the 20th. [who does what, and by when – two names, two dates]

Mei Ling asked whether this should have been raised in 2011. No answer was given. [one thing that was said and not resolved, recorded anyway]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The decision comes before the reasons. **Why?**
2. The last line records a question with no answer. **Should minutes do that?**

8B • The anti-model

There was a good discussion about the notice. Various views were expressed and everybody had a chance to speak. It was felt that more time was needed. The meeting closed at 11.40.

Correct English, and nobody could act on it tomorrow. **Name three things it does not say.**

8C • Plan

who was there → the decision, in one sentence → who does what, by when → one thing that was not resolved

8D • Write — 90 words

8E • Peer review — two criteria

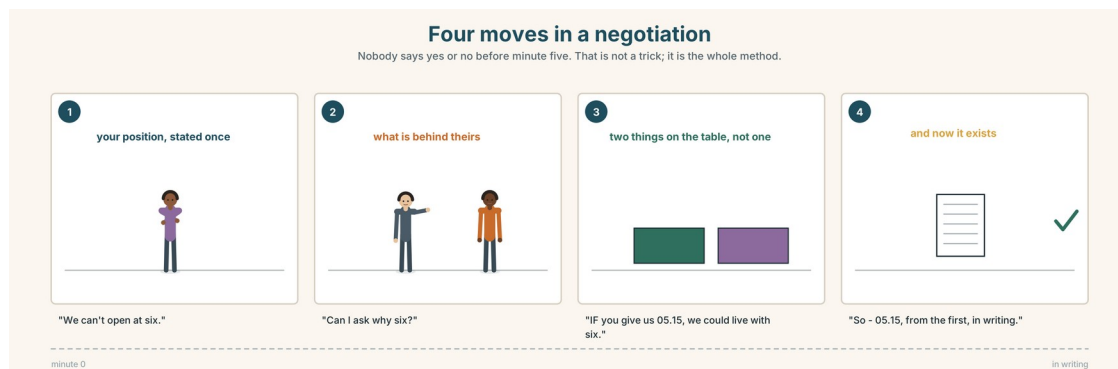
☐ Could somebody who was not there act on this? ☐ Is there a name and a date against every action?

8F • Write it again • 8G • Publish

On the wall, with the notice from Part 5E beside it.

Part 9 • The File ♦ A • THE WORLD + C • THE PERFORMANCE

WORK FILE • The Negotiation



{width=6.

6in}

Four moves in a negotiation — Nobody says yes or no before minute five. That is not a trick; it is the whole method.

9A • Twenty minutes, two sides 📻 Track 10.4

The traders want the opening hour unchanged. The city office wants it moved. **Listen.**

1. What does each side say it wants in the first minute?
2. **What does each side actually need?** They are not the same thing.
3. Who makes the first offer, and does that help them?

9B • The four moves

stating your position • finding what is behind theirs • making a conditional offer • writing it down

Match each to one phrase.

"We can't open at six." • "Can I ask why six?" • "If you can give us the 05.15 slot, we could live with six." • "So — 05.15, from the first, and we'll confirm in writing."

9C • The word that moves a negotiation

if

"We'll accept six." — nothing left to trade. **"If you give us the early slot, we'll accept six."** — now there are two things on the table.

Rewrite these three as conditional offers.

1. We'll pay the extra.
2. We'll drop the objection.
3. We'll take the corner pitch.

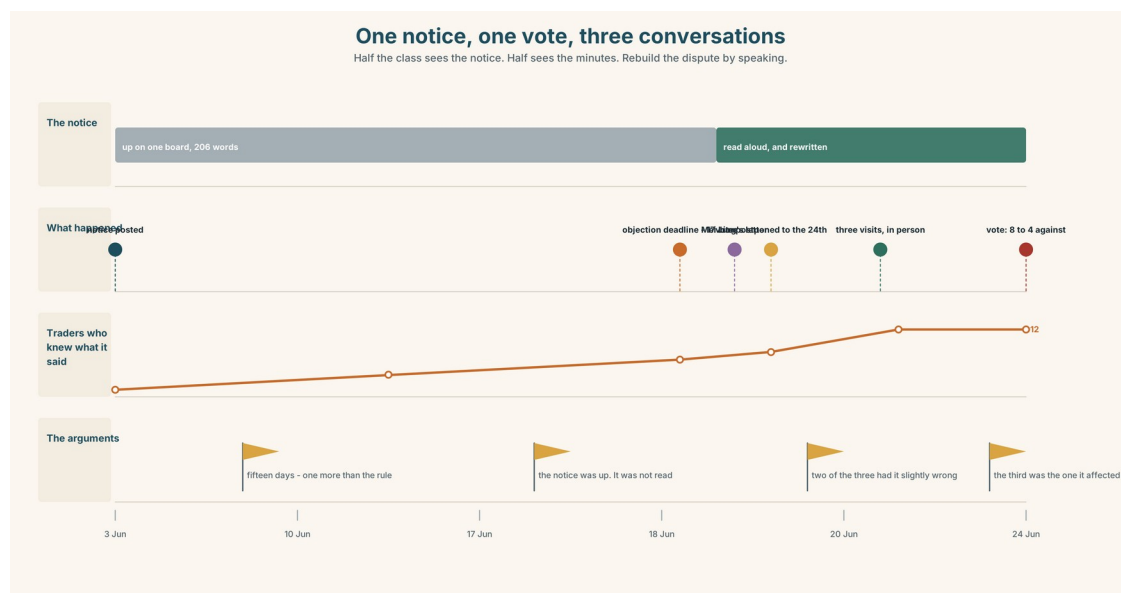
9D • Your turn

In pairs. **Ten minutes.** One of you wants a change. The other does not. **Neither of you may say yes or no before minute five.** Both must leave with something written.

9E • Transfer

Find one thing you want this week and ask for it with *if*. Bring what happened.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



6in}

One notice, one vote, three conversations — Half the class sees the notice. Half sees the minutes. Rebuild the dispute by speaking.

10A • Relay

Half the class sees the notice. Half sees the minutes. **Rebuild the whole dispute by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify

Explain the notice from Part 5E to a trader who reads very little English. **Four sentences only, and no sentence over twelve words.**

Plan: what is changing → from when → what you can do → by when

10C • Compress

The two letters in Part 5 into **thirty-five words**, as an entry in the minutes.

10D • Online

Write **one message** to the traders' group: the vote is postponed to the 24th, here is why in one sentence, and here is what you want three people to do before then.

10E • Your language

How does your language check something you half-know? **Is there a tag, or a particle, or do you change the intonation?** Show a partner *you put it up last week, didn't you?* in both languages, rising and falling.

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Before the vote

Twelve traders vote on the 24th. Three of them cannot read the notice. The rules have been followed exactly.

- **Vote as planned.** Fifteen days' notice, correctly posted. The rules exist so that nobody has to make this judgement.
- **Read it aloud and vote.** Five minutes at the start of the meeting. Three people hear it for the first time in the room where they must vote on it.
- **Visit all three first, then vote.** Three conversations, a week, and a precedent that the next manager may not keep.

11A • The evidence

1. **The notice** from Part 5E — its length, and its forty-one-word sentence.
2. **The chart** — who has spoken at the last twelve meetings, and for how long.
3. **The voice.** One of the three, fifteen seconds, through an interpreter: *"I have voted thirty-one times. I have never read any of them. Somebody always tells me, and I have always wondered what they left out."*

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Everybody says one. Use the frame.

I think the committee should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: *fair • unfair • vote • listen • have a say • quiet • speak out • turn*

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the committee should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Visit all three, and then change the notice. The visit fixes this vote; the notice is what caused it. Forty-one-word sentences and a board by the office are a system that works for the people who already know what the notice says, and the test of a notice is not whether it was posted but whether the twelve people who must vote on it know what they are voting on.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. Mr Tan visited all three. Two of them had already heard about the rule and had it slightly wrong. The third had not heard about it at all and turned out to be the person it affected most.

The vote on the 24th went 8–4 against the rule. On the old notice it would almost certainly have gone through, because two of the four against were among the three he visited.

The notice is now written in short sentences and read aloud at the start of every meeting. Nobody has complained about the five minutes. Four people have said it is the most useful five minutes of the meeting.

Three conversations changed the result. And the quickest fix was the one that cost nothing.

Was it the right decision? Say why — and say whether a rule should have been needed to make it happen.

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — ten items

1. You put it up last week, _____ ?
2. Nobody has read it, _____ ?
3. Could you tell me _____ the office is?
4. Everybody should **have a** _____ .
5. **Can I** _____ **say** something?
6. (Unit 9) It's _____ expensive for us.
7. (Unit 9) There are _____ many cameras.
8. (Unit 8) We're _____ to sign in, but nobody does.
9. (Unit 5) If it _____ (rain), we'll stay.
10. (Starting Out) What time _____ the meeting start?

12B • Consolidate

Ninety words. The minutes of a meeting, real or invented. Who was there, the decision in one sentence, two actions with names and dates, and one thing not resolved.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

I can...	My evidence	Sure?
check something I half-know, politely	Part 3G score	☐ ☒ ☒
chair ten minutes and name the decision	Part 4C recording	☐ ☒ ☒
write ninety words somebody absent could	Part 8 draft 2	☐ ☒ ☒

I can...	My evidence	Sure?
act on		
make a conditional offer in a negotiation	Part 9D role play	☐ ☒ ☒

12D • Replay

Find your thirty seconds from Part 0C. Listen. **Record it again.** One sentence: what is different?

12E • Glossary — forty items, as a map

THE MEETING · meeting · agenda · minutes · chair · turn · take turns · vote **WHAT COMES OUT OF IT** · decision · suggestion · opinion · argument · agree · disagree **WHO SPEAKS** · interrupt · listen · speak up · speak out · quiet · put your hand up · hear from · have a say · can I just say **FAIR OR NOT** · fair · unfair **ASKING CAREFULLY** · could · would you mind · could you tell me · do you know if · I was wondering · perhaps · actually · sorry · might · go on · if you don't mind **CHECKING** · isn't it? · aren't they? · do you? · don't you?

12F • Next

A2.2 • Telling the Story — Ballinmore, eight months after the storm.

End of A2.1 • Making Plans

Four hundred active items. Sixteen new structures. Ten decisions, none of which had a right answer, and seven of which cost somebody something.

Look back at your recording from Unit 1, Part 0C. Listen to it once. Then record the same thirty seconds again. **One sentence: what is different?**